

Brain-Based Mental Health Community

Dyadic Developmental Psychotherapy (DDP) Feedback

NAME

DATE

Review the live website before providing feedback:

<https://tcfasd.github.io/Brain-Based-Mental-Health-/handout-therapy-guide.html>

Also known as: Attachment-Focused Family TherapyChildren & Teens | Brain-Based Fit: Strong (especially foster/adoptive families)

What It Asks the Brain to Do:

DDP creates felt safety in the therapy room so the child's brain can come out of defensive survival states (fight, flight, freeze) and move into connection and co-regulation. It is built around the attitude of PACE: Playfulness, Acceptance, Curiosity, and Empathy. The therapist uses PACE to help the child experience safety, connection, and being understood, rather than constant defensiveness. Over time, DDP helps the child's brain build new meanings about themselves and their experiences, and supports the experience of being truly known and understood by another person — which helps organize and support a developing brain.

Caregiver Involvement:

Very high — caregivers are central to DDP. The child's healing is supported through the caregiver–child relationship as the therapist supports and coaches both toward safety and connection.

How to Know If It Might Be a Good Fit:

- Your child has a history of abuse, neglect, or multiple placement disruptions
- Your child has difficulty trusting caregivers or accepting comfort
- Your child is adopted, fostered, or in kinship care
- Attachment and relationship are the primary concerns, not just behavior

Brain-Based Consideration

:DDP's relational approach is well-suited for children with brain-based differences who also have co-occurring attachment disruptions — which is common among children with FASD who have histories of foster care or adoption. The emphasis on the caregiver's inner state (not just techniques) helps caregivers manage their own frustration and grief. The verbal and narrative elements may need adaptation for children with significant cognitive, language, and processing differences.

1. Is what is written accurate?

Yes

No

Yes

2. Is there additional information that you think caregivers should know about Dyadic Developmental Psychotherapy (DDP)?

Thank you for your feedback!